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Do You Run Out of Money Before You Run Out of Month?

Just about the time you think you can make both ends meet, somebody moves the ends.

—*Pansy Penner*

There are only two legitimate ways to improve your financial status—increase your income or decrease your expenses. You usually don't have as much control over the former, especially if you are at your boss's mercy. And it's probably not a good idea to consistently ask for your paycheck in advance! You could choose to work more jobs, but then you will have relinquished control over your free time.

One area we do have more control over is where we spend our money, and spending money is something that young adults love to do. According to Teenage Research Unlimited, teens age twelve to nineteen spent \$159 billion in 2005. Because young adults are such a large demographic group and combined have an enormous spending power, they are heavily marketed to by companies eager to capture some of this money. Evidence of this trend can be found in the emergence of a multitude of websites marketing items specifically to young adults. In addition, young adult versions of mainstream magazines, such as *Teen People*, line bookshelves.

Although young adults have more money than ever